

.....

GENERAL SKILLS: ORIENTATION AND ANALYZING BEHAVIOR

.....

Introduction to Handouts and Worksheets

There are two sets of handouts and worksheets in this part of the book. The first covers **Orientation**, which typically takes place during the first session of a new skills group, or when new members join an ongoing skills group. The purpose of orientation is to introduce members to one another and to the skills trainers, and to orient members to the format, rules, and meeting times of the particular skills training program. As described below, General Handouts 1 through 5 cover these issues, along with General Worksheet 1. General Handouts 6 through 8, and their corresponding worksheets, cover two important general skills for **Analyzing Behavior**: chain analysis and missing-links analysis. These are also described below.

Orientation

- **General Handout 1: Goals of Skills Training.** This handout lists the general and the specific goals of DBT skills training. Use this handout to think how you could personally benefit from skills training. Which areas are you most interested in? Use **General Worksheet 1: Pros and Cons of Using Skills** any time you aren't sure whether there are benefits to practicing DBT skills. Be sure to fill out the pros and cons for both the option of practicing skills and the option of not practicing.
- **General Handout 1a: Options for Solving Any Problem.** Although there are many, many things that can cause us pain, our options for responding to pain are limited. We can solve the problem that is causing the pain. We can try to feel better by changing our emotional response to the pain. Or we can accept and tolerate the

problem and our response. Each of these options requires use of one or more DBT skills. The final option is to stay miserable (or make things worse) and use no skills.*

- **General Handout 3: Guidelines for Skills Training.** This handout lists the guidelines for most standard DBT skills programs. These are standards of behavior that people in a group skills program are asked to follow. Some programs may have somewhat modified guidelines.

- **General Handout 4: Skills Training Assumptions.** Assumptions are beliefs that cannot be proved. In DBT skills training, all group members and skills trainers are asked to abide by these assumptions.

- **General Handout 5: Biosocial Theory.** Biosocial theory is an explanation of how and why some people find it challenging to manage their emotions and actions. DBT skills are particularly useful for these people.

Analyzing Behavior

- **General Handout 6: Overview: Analyzing Behavior.** This handout previews the two general skills for analyzing behavior—chain analysis and missing-links analysis.

- **General Handout 7: Chain Analysis.** Any behavior can be understood as a series of linked parts. These links are “chained” together because they follow each other—one link in the chain leads to another. Chain analysis is a way of determining what has caused a behavior and what maintains it. This handout provides a series of questions (e.g., “What happened before that? What happened next?”) for unlocking the links in a behavior chain that can feel stuck together. It guides you through figuring out what factors led to a problem behavior and what factors might be making it difficult to change that behavior. Knowing this is important if you want to change the behavior.

- **General Handout 7a: Chain Analysis, Step by Step.** This handout explains in greater detail how to do a chain analysis. **General Worksheet 2: Chain Analysis of Problem Behavior** is a worksheet for doing a chain analysis. Use it with General Handouts 7 and 7a, which have the same steps. **General Worksheet 2a: Example: Chain Analysis of Problem Behavior** is a completed sample version of General Worksheet 2.

- **General Handout 8: Missing-Links Analysis.** Missing-links analysis is a series of questions to help you figure out what got in the way of behaving effectively. Use it to identify why something did not happen that was needed and that you agreed to do, planned to do, or hoped to do. **General Worksheet 3: Missing-Links Analysis** can be used with this handout.

*This last option was suggested to me in an e-mail. Unfortunately, I simply cannot find the message so that I can properly credit the person here. Nevertheless, it was a fabulous addition.

.....

General Handouts

Orientation Handouts

.....



Goals of Skills Training

GENERAL GOAL

To learn how to change your own behaviors, emotions, and thoughts that are linked to problems in living and are causing misery and distress.

SPECIFIC GOALS

Behaviors to Decrease:

- ☐ Mindlessness; emptiness; being out of touch with self and others; judgmentalness.
- ☐ Interpersonal conflict and stress; loneliness.
- ☐ Absence of flexibility; difficulties with change.
- ☐ Up-and-down and extreme emotions; mood-dependent behavior; difficulties in regulating emotions.
- ☐ Impulsive behaviors; acting without thinking; difficulties accepting reality as it is; willfulness; addiction.

Skills to Increase:

- ☐ Mindfulness skills.
- ☐ Interpersonal effectiveness skills.
- ☐ Emotion regulation skills.
- ☐ Distress tolerance skills.

PERSONAL GOALS

Behaviors to Decrease:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Skills to Increase:

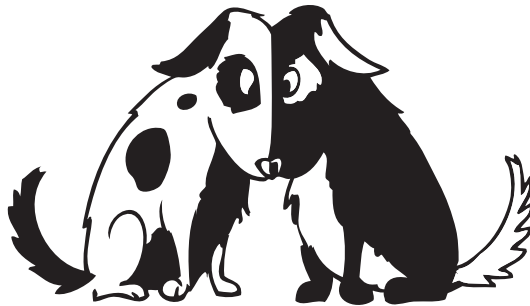
1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

What Is Dialectical Behavior Therapy (DBT)?

- DBT is an effective treatment for people who have difficulty controlling their emotions and behaviors.
- DBT aims to replace problem behaviors with skillful behaviors.
- DBT skills help people experience a range of emotions without necessarily acting on those emotions.
- DBT skills help folks navigate relationships in their environment (family/school/peers).
- DBT helps people create a life worth living.

What Does “Dialectical” Mean?

Dialectical = two opposite ideas can be true at the same time, and when considered together, can create a new truth and a new way of viewing the situation. There is always more than one way to think about a situation.



Dialectics - thinking in a balanced way

Dialectical = Two seemingly opposite ideas can be true at the same time.

Dialectical thinking enables a person to:

- View behaviors within a whole context
- Entertain different perspectives in others and within oneself
- Recognize that two things that seem like opposites can both be true
- Find less extreme and more effective ways of thinking (Linehan, 1993)

Can you think of an example of a dialectic in your life?



Options for Solving Any Problem

When life presents you with problems, what are your options?

1. SOLVE THE PROBLEM

Change the situation . . . or avoid, leave, or get out of the situation for good.

2. FEEL BETTER ABOUT THE PROBLEM

Change (or regulate) your emotional response to the problem.

3. TOLERATE THE PROBLEM

Accept and tolerate both the problem and your response to the problem.

4. STAY MISERABLE

Or possibly make it worse!

1. TO PROBLEM-SOLVE:

Use interpersonal effectiveness skills

Walking the Middle Path (from interpersonal effectiveness skills)

Use problem-solving skills (from emotion regulation skills)

2. TO FEEL BETTER ABOUT THE PROBLEM:

Use emotion regulation skills

3. TO TOLERATE THE PROBLEM:

Use distress tolerance and mindfulness skills

4. TO STAY MISERABLE:

Use *no* skills!

**Overview:
Introduction to Skills Training**

GUIDELINES FOR SKILLS TRAINING

SKILLS TRAINING ASSUMPTIONS

**BIOSOCIAL THEORY
OF EMOTIONAL AND
BEHAVIORAL DYSREGULATION**



Guidelines for Skills Training

1. Participants who drop out of skills training are *not* out of skills training.

- a. The only way out is to miss four scheduled sessions of skills training in a row.

2. Participants who join the skills training group support each other and:

- a. Keep names of other participants and information obtained during sessions confidential.
- b. Come to each group session on time and stay until the end.
- c. Make every effort to practice skills between sessions.
- d. Validate each other, avoid judging each other, and assume the best about each other.
- e. Give helpful, noncritical feedback when asked.
- f. Are willing to accept help from a person they ask or call for help.

3. Participants who join the skills training group:

- a. Call ahead of time if they are going to be late or miss a session.

4. Participants do not tempt others to engage in problem behaviors and:

- a. Do not come to sessions under the influence of drugs or alcohol.
- b. If drugs or alcohol have already been used, come to sessions acting and appearing clean and sober.
- c. Do not discuss, inside or outside sessions, current or past problem behaviors that could be contagious to others.

5. Participants do not form confidential relationships with each other outside of skills training sessions and:

- a. Do not start a sexual or a private relationship that cannot be discussed in group.
- b. Are not partners in risky behaviors, crime, or drug use.

Other guidelines for this group/notes:



Skills Training Assumptions

**An assumption is a belief that cannot be proved,
but we agree to abide by it anyway.**

1. People are doing the best they can.

All people at any given point in time are doing the best they can.

2. People want to improve.

The common characteristic of all people is that they want to improve their lives and be happy.

3. People need to do better, try harder, and be more motivated to change.*

The fact that people are doing the best they can, and want to do even better, does not mean that these things are enough to solve the problem.

4. People may not have caused all of our own problems, but they have to solve them anyway.**

People have to change their own behavioral responses and alter their environment for their life to change.

5. New behavior has to be learned in all relevant contexts.

New behavioral skills have to be practiced in the situations where the skills are needed, not just in the situation where the skills are first learned.

6. All behaviors (actions, thoughts, emotions) are caused.

There is always a cause or set of causes for our actions, thoughts, and emotions, even if we do not know what the causes are.

7. Figuring out and changing the causes of behavior work better than judging and blaming.

Judging and blaming are easier, but if we want to create change in the world, we have to change the chains of events that cause unwanted behaviors and events.

*But trying harder and being more motivated may not be needed if progress is steady and at a realistic rate of improvement.

**Parents and caregivers must assist children in this task.

From *DBT Skills Training Handouts and Worksheets, Second Edition* by Marsha M. Linehan. Copyright 2015 by Marsha M. Linehan. Permission to photocopy this handout is granted to purchasers of this book for personal use only (see copyright page for details).

DBT Assumptions - Practice Exercise

- Which assumption do you think will help you the most?
- Which assumption challenges you the most?
- Reflect on a recent situation in which being mindful of an assumption could have changed your feelings or behavior

Assumptions Reminders:

- People are doing the best they can.
- People want to improve.
- People need to do better, try harder, and be more motivated to change.
- People may not have caused all of their own problems and they have to solve them anyway.
- The lives of emotionally distressed people are painful as they are currently being lived.
- Individuals must learn and practice new behaviors in all the different situations in their lives
- There is no absolute truth.
- Individuals cannot fail in DBT.

Biosocial Theory

Interaction between:

- The Biology of a person
- Their social environments

Some people have extra trouble controlling emotions and actions; some people feel emotions and action urges more intensely.

Biosocial Theory

Why do I have so much trouble controlling
my emotions and my actions?

**Emotional vulnerability is BIOLOGICAL:
It's simply how some people are born.**

- ☐ They are more **sensitive** to emotional stimuli; they can detect subtle emotional information in the environment that others don't even notice.
 - ☐ They experience emotions **much more often** than others.
 - ☐ Their emotions seem to hit for no reason, from **out of the blue**.
- ☐ They have more **intense** emotions.
 - ☐ Their emotions hit like a **ton of bricks**.
 - ☐ And their emotions are **long-lasting**.

**Impulsivity also has a BIOLOGICAL basis:
Regulating action is harder for some than for others.**

- ☐ They find it **very hard to restrain** impulsive behaviors.
 - ☐ Often, without thinking, they do things that **get them in trouble**.
 - ☐ Sometimes their **behavior seems to come out of nowhere**.
- ☐ They find it very **hard to be effective**.
 - ☐ Their moods get in the way of **organizing** to achieve their goals.
 - ☐ They **cannot control** behaviors linked to their moods.

(continued on next page)

**An invalidating SOCIAL environment
can make it very hard to regulate emotions.**

- ☐ An invalidating environment doesn't seem to understand your emotions.
 - ☐ It tells you your emotions are ***invalid, weird, wrong, or bad.***
 - ☐ It often ***ignores*** your emotional reactions and does nothing to help you.
 - ☐ It may say things like *"Don't be such a baby!" "Quit your blubbering." "Quit being such a chicken and just solve the problem." or "Normal people don't get this frustrated."*
- ☐ People who invalidate are **OFTEN DOING THE BEST THEY CAN.**
 - ☐ They ***may not know*** how to validate or how important it is to validate, or they ***may be afraid*** that if they validate your emotions, you will get more emotional, not less.
 - ☐ They ***may be under high stress*** or time pressure, or they may have too few resources themselves.
 - ☐ There may be just a ***poor fit*** between you and your social environment:
You may be a tulip in a rose garden.

**An ineffective SOCIAL environment
is a big problem when you want
to learn to regulate emotions and actions.**

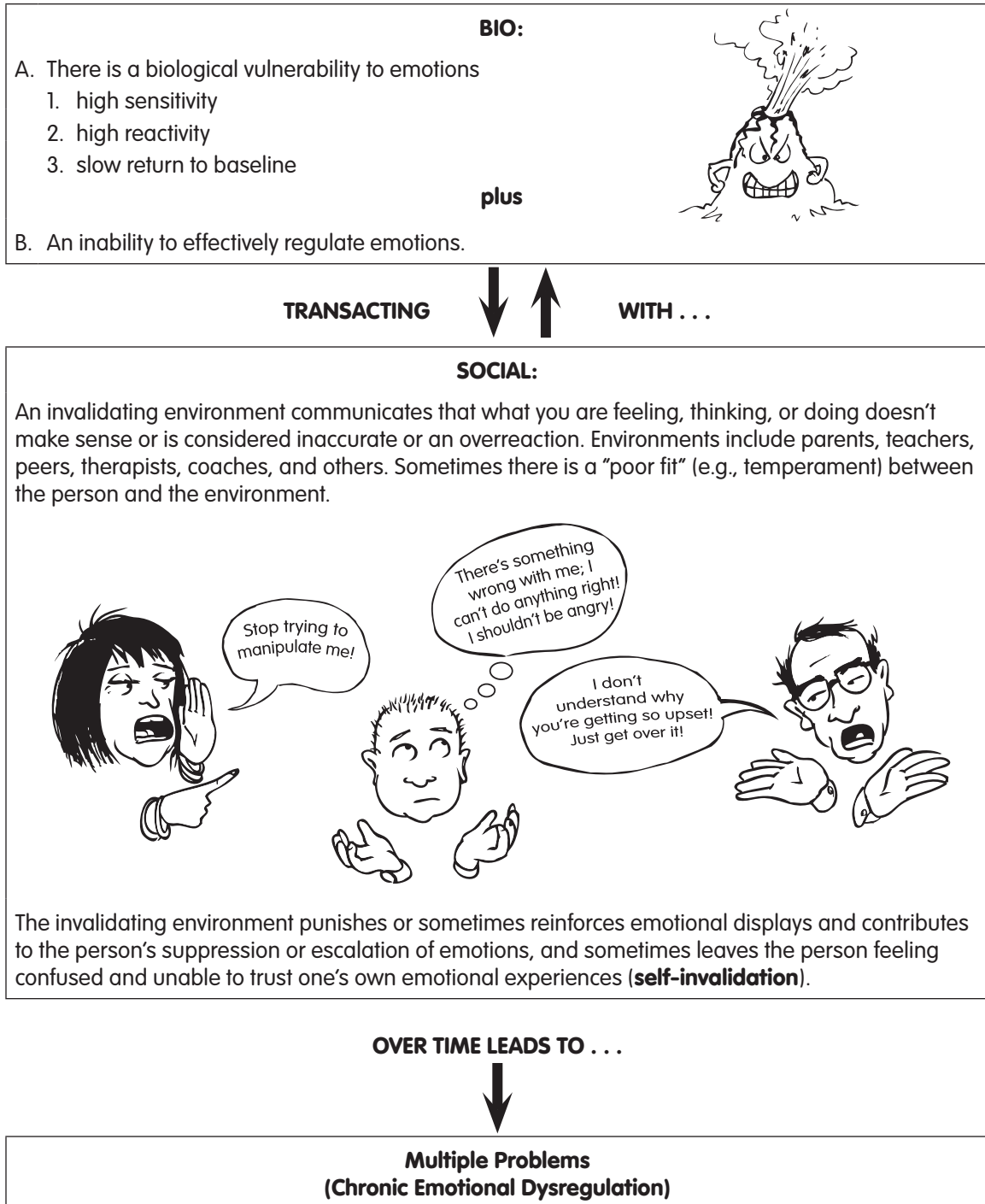
- ☐ Your environment may ***reinforce out-of-control emotions and actions.***
 - ☐ If people give in when you get out of control, it will be hard for you to get in control.
 - ☐ If others command you to change, but don't coach you on how to do this, it will be hard to keep on trying to change.

**It's the TRANSACTIONS that count
between the person and the social environment.**

- ☐ Biology and the social environment influence the person.
- ☐ The person reciprocates and influences his or her social environment.
- ☐ The social environment reciprocates and influences the person.
- ☐ And so on and on and on.

ORIENTATION HANDOUT 4

Biosocial Theory



From *DBT® Skills Manual for Adolescents*, by Jill H. Rathus and Alec L. Miller. Copyright 2015 by The Guilford Press. Permission to photocopy this handout is granted to purchasers of this book for personal use only (see copyright page for details).

.....

Handouts for Analyzing Behavior

.....

Overview: Analyzing Behavior

**To figure out its causes
and plan for problem solving.**

Chain Analysis is for when you engage in ineffective behavior.

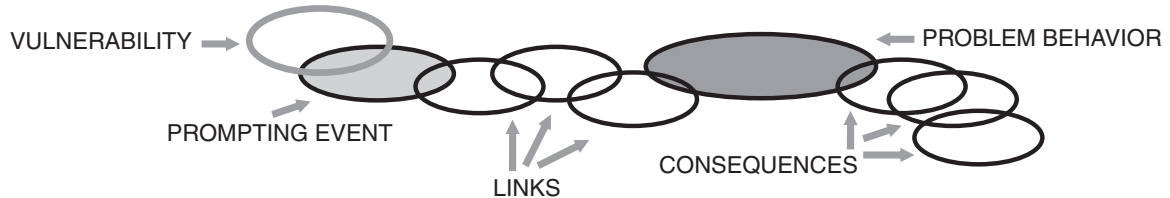
A chain analysis examines the chain of events that leads to ineffective behaviors, as well as the consequences of those behaviors that may be making it hard to change them. It also helps you figure out how to repair the damage.

Missing-Links Analysis is for when you fail to engage in effective behaviors.

A missing-links analysis helps you identify what got in the way of doing things you needed or hoped to do, things you agreed to do, or things others expected you to do. It also helps you problem-solve for the future.

Chain Analysis

TO UNDERSTAND BEHAVIOR, DO A CHAIN ANALYSIS.



Step 1: Describe the **PROBLEM BEHAVIOR**.

Step 2: Describe the **PROMPTING EVENT** that started the chain of events leading to the problem behavior.

Step 3: Describe the factors happening before the event that made you **VULNERABLE** to starting down the chain of events toward the problem behavior.

Step 4: Describe in excruciating detail the **CHAIN OF EVENTS** that led to the problem behavior.

Step 5: Describe the **CONSEQUENCES** of the problem behavior.

To change behavior:

Step 6: Describe **SKILLFUL** behaviors to replace problem links in the chain of events.

Step 7: Develop **PREVENTION PLANS** to reduce vulnerability to stressful events.

Step 8: **REPAIR** important or significant consequences of the problem behavior.

Chain Analysis, Step by Step

- 1. Describe the specific PROBLEM BEHAVIOR** (overeating or overdrinking, yelling at your kids, throwing a chair, having an overwhelming emotional outburst, dissociating, not coming or coming late to skills training, putting off or refusing to do skills practice, etc.).
 - A. Be very specific and detailed. No vague terms.
 - B. Identify exactly what *you did, said, thought, or felt* (if feelings are the targeted problem behavior). Identify what *you did not do*.
 - C. Describe the intensity of the behavior and other characteristics of the behavior that are important.
 - D. Describe the problem behavior in enough detail that an actor in a play or movie could recreate the behavior exactly.
 - E. If the behavior is something *you did not do*, ask yourself whether (a) you did not know you needed to do it (it did not get into short-term memory); (b) you forgot it and later it never came into your mind to do it (it did not get into long-term memory); (c) you put it off when you did think of it; (d) you refused to do it when you thought of it; or (e) you were willful and rejected doing it, or some other behavior, thoughts, or emotions interfered with doing it. If (a) or (b) is the case, skip from here to Step 6 below (working on solutions). Otherwise, keep going from here.
- 2. Describe the specific PROMPTING EVENT** that started the whole chain of behavior. Begin with the environmental event that started the chain. Always begin with some event in your environment, even if it doesn't seem to you that the environmental event "caused" the problem behavior. Otherwise, we could ask about any behavior, thought, feeling, or experience, "What prompted that?" Possible questions to help you get at this are:
 - A. What exact event precipitated the start of the chain reaction?
 - B. When did the sequence of events that led to the problem behavior begin? When did the problem start?
 - C. What was going on right before the thought of or impulse for the problem behavior occurred?
 - D. What were you doing/thinking/feeling/imagining at that time?
 - E. Why did the problem behavior happen on that day instead of the day before?
- 3. Describe specific VULNERABILITY FACTORS** happening before the prompting event. What factors or events made you more vulnerable to reacting to the prompting event with a problematic chain? Areas to examine are:
 - A. Physical illness; unbalanced eating or sleeping; injury.
 - B. Use of drugs or alcohol; misuse of prescription drugs.
 - C. Stressful events in the environment (either positive or negative).
 - D. Intense emotions, such as sadness, anger, fear, loneliness.
 - E. Previous behaviors of your own that you found stressful coming into your mind.

(continued on next page)

4. **Describe in excruciating detail the CHAIN OF EVENTS** that led to the problem behavior. Imagine that your problem behavior is chained to the precipitating event in the environment. How long is the chain? Where does it go? What are the links? Write out all **links** in the chain of events, no matter how small. Be very specific, as if you are writing a script for a play. Links in the chain can be:
- A. Actions or things you do.
 - B. Body sensations or feelings.
 - C. Cognitions (i.e., beliefs, expectations, or thoughts).
 - D. Events in the environment or things others do.
 - E. Feelings and emotions that you experience.
- What exact thought (or belief), feeling, or action followed the prompting event? What thought, feeling, or action followed that? What next? What next? And so forth.
- Look at each link in the chain after you write it. Was there another thought, feeling, or action that could have occurred? Could someone else have thought, felt, or acted differently at that point? If so, explain how that specific thought, feeling, or action came to be.
 - For each link in the chain, ask whether there is a smaller link you could describe.
5. **Describe the CONSEQUENCES** of this behavior. Be specific. (How did other people react immediately and later? How did you feel immediately following the behavior? Later? What effect did the behavior have on you and your environment?)
6. **Describe in detail** at each point where you could have used a **skillful** behavior to head off the problem behavior. What key links were most important in leading to the problem behavior? (In other words, if you had eliminated these behaviors, the problem behavior probably would not have happened.)
- A. Go back to the chain of behaviors following the prompting event. Circle each link where, if you had done something different, you would have avoided the problem behavior.
 - B. What could you have done differently at each link in the chain of events to avoid the problem behavior? What coping behaviors or skillful behaviors could you have used?
7. **Describe in detail a PREVENTION STRATEGY** for how you could have kept the chain from starting by reducing your vulnerability to the chain.
8. **Describe what you are going to do to REPAIR** important or significant consequences of the problem behavior.
- A. Analyze: What did you really harm? What was the negative consequence you can repair?
 - B. Look at the harm or distress you actually caused others, and the harm or distress you caused yourself. Repair what you damaged. (Don't bring flowers to repair a window you broke: fix the window! Repair a betrayal of trust by being very trustworthy long enough to fit the betrayal, rather than trying to fix it with love letters and constant apologies. Repair failure by succeeding, not by berating yourself.)

BEHAVIOR CHAIN ANALYSIS

1. PROBLEM BEHAVIOR

- Be specific
- What did you say or do?
- Describe the intensity of your behavior

2. PRECIPITATING EVENT

- What event triggered your behavior?

3. VULNERABILITY FACTORS

- Was there any factors that made you more vulnerable. Eg, stress, intense emotions, illness, substance abuse?

4. CHAIN OF EVENTS

- Imagine that each event is a link in a chain. Trace back all your links. Eg, emotions, sensations or behavior

5. CONSEQUENCES

- How did you feel after the event?
- How did other people feel?

6. SOLUTIONS

- Brainstorm things that you can do differently next time.

7. PREVENTION STRATEGY

- How can you reduce my vulnerability factors?

8. REPAIR

- What can you do to repair the consequences of my behavior?

Missing-Links Analysis

Ask the following questions to understand how and why effective behavior that is needed or expected did not occur.

- 1. Did you know what effective behavior was needed or expected (what skills homework was given, what skills to use, etc.)?**

IF NO to Question 1, ask what got in the way of knowing what was needed or expected. Ideas might include not paying attention, unclear instructions, never getting the instructions in the first place, becoming too overwhelmed and couldn't process the information, and so on.

PROBLEM-SOLVE what got in the way. For example, you might work on paying attention, ask for clarification when you don't understand instructions, call others, look up information, and so on.

- 2. IF YES to Question 1, ask were you willing to do the needed or expected effective behavior?**

IF NO to Question 2, ask what got in the way of willingness to do effective behaviors. Ideas might include willfulness, feeling inadequate, or feeling demoralized.

PROBLEM-SOLVE what got in the way of willingness. For example, you might practice radical acceptance, do pros and cons, practice opposite action, and so on.

- 3. IF YES to Question 2, ask did the thought of doing the needed or expected effective behavior ever enter your mind?**

IF NO to Question 3,

PROBLEM-SOLVE how to get the thought of doing effective behaviors into your mind. For example, you might put it on your calendar, set your alarm to go off, put your skills notebook next to your bed, practice coping ahead with difficult situations (see Emotion Regulation Handout 19), and so on.

- 4. IF YES to Question 3, ask what got in the way of doing the needed or expected effective behavior right away?** Ideas might include putting it off, continuing to procrastinate, not being in the mood, forgetting how to do what was needed, thinking that no one would care anyway (or no one would find out), and so on.

PROBLEM-SOLVE what got in the way. For example, you might set a reward for doing what is expected, practice opposite action, do pros and cons, and so on.

.....

General Worksheets

Orientation Worksheet

.....

Pros and Cons of Using Skills

Due Date: _____ Name: _____ Week Starting: _____

Use this worksheet to figure out the advantages and disadvantages to you of using skills (i.e., acting skillfully) to reach your goals. The idea here is to figure out what is the most effective way for you to get what you want in life. Remember, this is about your goals, not someone else's goals.

Describe the situation or problem:**Describe your goal in this situation:**

Make a list of the Pros and Cons of practicing your skills in this situation.

Make another list of the Pros and Cons for not practicing your skills or of not practicing them completely.

Check the facts to be sure that you are correct in your assessment of advantages and disadvantages.

Write on the back if you need more space.

PROS	Practicing Skills _____ _____ _____ _____	Not Practicing Skills _____ _____ _____ _____
	Practicing Skills _____ _____ _____ _____	Not Practicing Skills _____ _____ _____ _____

What did you decide to do in this situation? _____

Is this the best decision (in Wise Mind)? _____

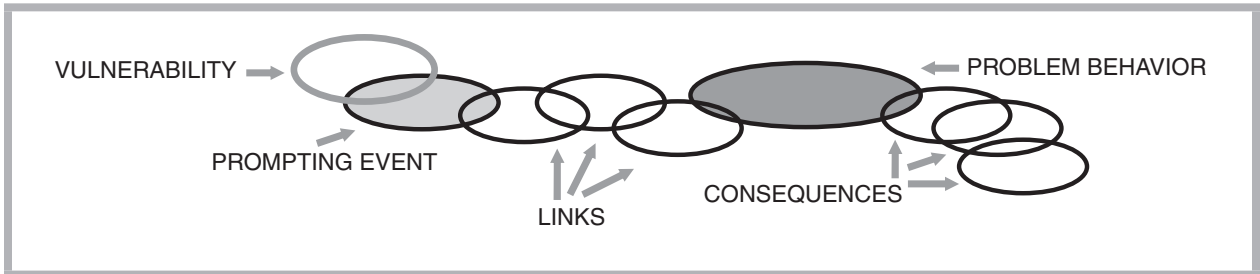
.....

Worksheets for Analyzing Behavior

.....

Chain Analysis of Problem Behavior

Due Date: _____ Name: _____ Date: _____



1. What exactly is the major **PROBLEM BEHAVIOR** that I am analyzing?

2. What **PROMPTING EVENT** in the environment started me on the chain to my problem behavior? Include what happened **RIGHT BEFORE** the urge or thought came into my mind.

Day prompting event occurred: _____

3. Describe what things in myself and in my environment made me **VULNERABLE**.

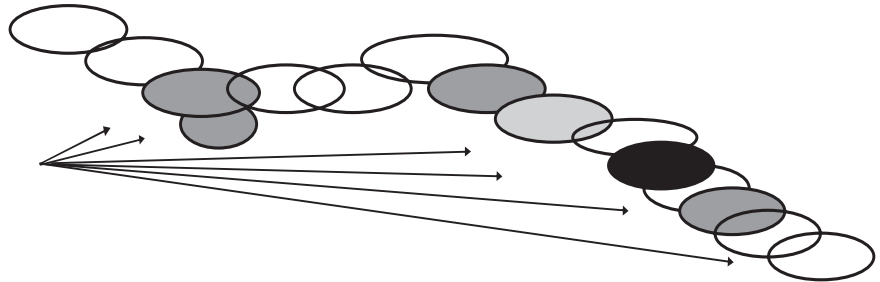
Day the events making me vulnerable started: _____

(continued on next page)

LINKS IN THE CHAIN OF EVENTS: Behaviors (Actions, Body sensations, Cognitions/Thoughts, Feelings) and Events (in the environment)

Possible Types of Links

- A. Actions
- B. Body sensations
- C. Cognitions/thoughts
- E. Events
- F. Feelings



4. List the **chain of events** (specific behaviors and environmental events that actually did happen). Use the ABC-EF list above.

1st. _____

2nd. _____

3rd. _____

4th. _____

5th. _____

6th. _____

7th. _____

8th. _____

9th. _____

6. List new, more **skillful** behaviors to replace ineffective behaviors. Use the ABC-EF list.

1st. _____

2nd. _____

3rd. _____

4th. _____

5th. _____

6th. _____

7th. _____

8th. _____

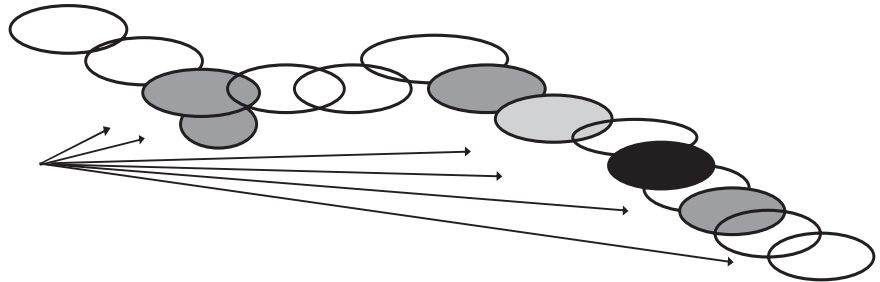
9th. _____

(continued on next page)

LINKS IN THE CHAIN OF EVENTS: Behaviors (Actions, Body sensations, Cognitions/Thoughts, Feelings) and Events (in the environment)

Possible Types of Links

- A. Actions
- B. Body sensations
- C. Cognitions/thoughts
- E. Events
- F. Feelings



4. List the **chain of events** (specific behaviors and environmental events that actually did happen). Use the ABC-EF list above.

10th. _____

11th. _____

12th. _____

13th. _____

14th. _____

15th. _____

16th. _____

17th. _____

6. List new, more **skillful** behaviors to replace ineffective behaviors. Use the ABC-EF list.

10th. _____

11th. _____

12th. _____

13th. _____

14th. _____

15th. _____

16th. _____

17th. _____

(continued on next page)

5. What exactly were the *consequences* in the environment?

And in myself?

What *harm* did my problem behavior cause?

7. *Prevention plans:*

Ways to reduce my *vulnerability* in the future:

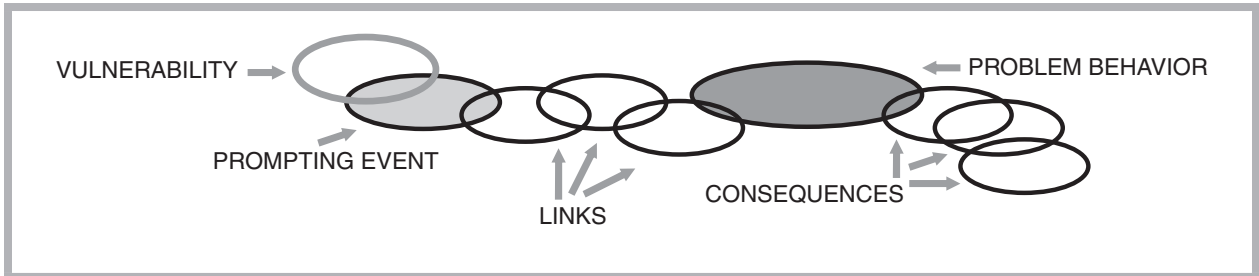
Ways to prevent *precipitating event* from happening again:

8. Plans to *repair*, correct, and overcorrect the harm:

Example: Chain Analysis of Problem Behavior

Due Date: _____ Name: _____ Date: _____

Problem Behavior: _____



1. What exactly is the major **PROBLEM BEHAVIOR** that I am analyzing?

Drinking too much and driving drunk

2. What **PROMPTING EVENT** in the environment started me on the chain to my problem behavior? Include what happened **RIGHT BEFORE** the urge or thought came into my mind.

Day prompting event occurred: Monday

My sister from out of town called me and said she was not going to come visit me the next week like she had said she would, because her husband had an important business party he wanted her to attend with him.

3. Describe what things in myself and in my environment made me **VULNERABLE**.

Day the events making me vulnerable started: Sunday

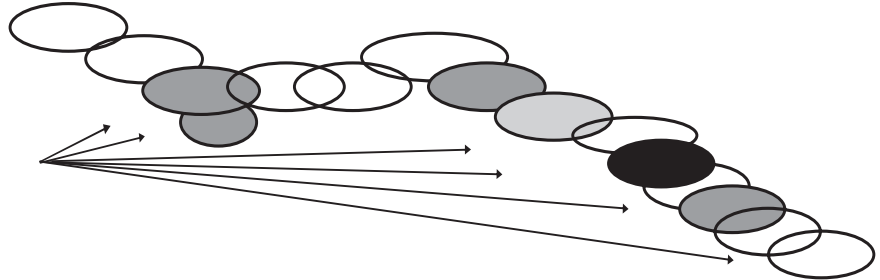
My boyfriend said he had to take a business trip sometime in the next month.

(continued on next page)

LINKS IN THE CHAIN OF EVENTS: Behaviors (Actions, Body sensations, Cognitions/Thoughts, Feelings) and Events (in the environment)

Possible Types of Links

- A. Actions
- B. Body sensations
- C. Cognitions/thoughts
- E. Events
- F. Feelings



4. List the **chain of events** (specific behaviors and environmental events that actually did happen). Use the ABC-EF list above.

1st. *I felt hurt and started sobbing on the phone with my sister and was angry with her.*

2nd. *I thought, "I can't stand it. No one loves me."*

3rd. *I felt very ashamed once I hung up from talking to my sister.*

4th. *I thought "My life is useless; no one will ever be here for me."*

5th. *Tried watching TV, but nothing was on I liked.*

6th. *I started feeling agitated and thought, "I can't stand this."*

7th. *I decided to drink a glass of wine to feel better, but ended up drinking two whole bottles.*

8th. *Got in my car to drive to a late-night concert.*

9th. *While I was bending down to pick up a piece of paper, car swerved. I was stopped by a cop and taken in on a DUI.*

6. List new, more **skillful** behaviors to replace ineffective behaviors. Use the ABC-EF list.

1st. *Listen to why my sister could not come.*

2nd. *Remember that my sister and my boyfriend love me.*

3rd. *Check the facts; is my sister going to reject me over this?*

4th. *Call my sister back and apologize for being angry (since I know she will validate how I feel).*

5th. *Download a movie, work on a puzzle, or call a friend instead.*

6th. *Try my TIP skills to bring down arousal.*

7th. *Walk down the street and have a dinner out, because I won't drink too much in public.*

8th. *Call my boyfriend and ask him to come over for a while.*

9th. *Take a long bath, try TIP skills again; Keep checking the facts; remember these emotions will pass; call my therapist for help.*

(continued on next page)

5. What exactly were the *consequences* in the environment?

Short-term: I had to spend the night in jail.

Long-term: My boyfriend has less trust in me; my sister is upset about it.

And in myself?

Short-term: I am ashamed and furious with myself.

Long-term: I will have to pay more for car insurance and may have trouble getting a job.

What *harm* did my problem behavior cause?

It hurt me by giving me a DUI record. My sister feels guilty because she upset me.

7. *Prevention plans:*

Ways to reduce my *vulnerability* in the future:

Make plans for how to cope whenever my boyfriend is out of town.

Ways to prevent *precipitating event* from happening again:

I can't keep the precipitating event from happening, so I need to practice coping ahead and have plans for how to manage when I am at home alone.

8. Plans to *repair, correct, and overcorrect* the harm:

Apologize to my sister and reassure her that she has a perfect right to change her plans. Work with her to plan a new time for a visit. Ask if it would be easier for her if I came to visit her.

Missing-Links Analysis

To understand missing effective behavior, do a missing-links analysis.

Due Date: _____ Name: _____ Date: _____

Missing Behavior: _____

Use this sheet to first figure out what got in the way of doing things you needed or hoped to do, or things you agreed to do or others expected you to do. Then use that information to problem-solve, so that you will be more likely to do what is needed, hoped for, or expected next time.

1. Did I know what effective behavior was needed or expected? Yes ____ No ____

IF NO to Question 1, what got in the way of knowing? _____

Describe problem solving: _____

STOP

2. IF YES to Question 1, was I willing to do what was needed? Yes ____ No ____

IF NO to Question 2, what got in the way of wanting to do what was needed? _____

Describe problem solving: _____

STOP

3. IF YES to Question 2, did the thought of doing what was needed or expected ever enter my mind? Yes ____ No ____

IF NO to Question 3, describe problem solving: _____

4. IF YES to Question 3, what got in the way of doing what was needed or expected right away?

_____ STOP

Describe problem solving: _____

_____ STOP